

SHIFT — Chapter One: “Grand Opening”

Client: Tante Layla

Concepts: Variables → Conditionals → Loops

Capstone: Live bug fix

Setting: Entire chapter takes place through Mohamed's LoopOS desktop.

PROLOGUE — “BEFORE”

LOOPOS — FIRST BOOT

Black screen.

A cursor blinks.

LOOPOS

Starting system...

A simple boot animation.

The login screen appears.

Mohamed logs in.

The desktop loads.

The room itself is never shown.

Instead, the player sees what Mohamed sees:

- Desktop wallpaper
- Taskbar
- Clock
- WhatsUpp
- MailLoop
- LoopCode
- Files
- Browser
- Settings

Several notifications are already waiting.

WhatsUpp — 7 unread messages

MailLoop — 4 unread emails

Missed LoopCall — 2

Mohamed ignores everything.

He opens an unrelated application.

The desktop is quiet.

Then—

NOTIFICATION

FATHER

My study. Today.

Mohamed stares at the notification.

He doesn't answer.

The notification remains.

After a moment, another message appears.

FATHER

Don't make me ask twice.

Mohamed finally opens WhatsApp.

A conversation with **Father**.

WHATSUPP — FATHER

Father:

Do you know why I named you Mohamed?

Mohamed types.

Mohamed:

Is this the third time you've asked me that?

The typing indicator appears.

Father:

Your grandfather built everything you've never once had to think about.

I gave you his name so people would expect something from you the moment they heard it.

Not because you'd earned it.

Because you'd have to.

Mohamed pauses.

He starts typing.

Stops.

Deletes it.

Types again.

Mohamed:

Great system. Very motivating.

The typing indicator appears immediately.

Father:

It hasn't worked.

Silence.

Then another message.

Father:

I'm done paying for a life you're not living.

The apartment.

The card.

All of it stops this month.

Mohamed doesn't respond.

Father:

Get a job.

Keep it.

Prove there's someone under my father's name, and not just the name.

The conversation stops.

Mohamed remains staring at the screen.

Then—

SYSTEM NOTIFICATION

New email received.

He opens MailLoop.

MAILLOOP — FATHER

Subject: You need to start somewhere.

There is no attachment.

Only one sentence:

Start somewhere.

Mohamed closes the email.

The desktop remains silent.

Then:

UNKNOWN EMAIL

Your application has been accepted.

Mohamed looks at it.

DAY ZERO — FIRST DAY AT LOOP

LOOPOS DESKTOP — 08:57 AM

The desktop wallpaper changes.

A new company wallpaper appears:

LOOP — Software Studio

A system notification:

Welcome to LoopOS.

Another:

New workplace account connected.

The taskbar updates.

New applications appear:

- WhatsUpp
- MailLoop
- LoopCode
- LoopFiles
- LoopCall

Mohamed opens WhatsUpp.

A new group already exists:

WHATSUPP — LOOP TEAM

Members:

- Youssef
- Nadine
- Tarek
- Mohamed

The first message arrives.

Tarek:

NEW GUY 🧐🧐

Another message.

Nadine:

We got one.

Mohamed:

One what?

Nadine:

Don't worry about it.

Tarek:

Mohamed right?

Mohamed:

Yes.

Tarek:

Perfect.

Can you start today?

Mohamed looks at the screen.

Mohamed:

I am literally logged in.

Tarek:

Great attitude already.

Nadine replies.

Nadine:

That's not what that means.

A few seconds later:

Youssef:

Ignore Tarek.

Welcome to Loop, Mohamed.

Mohamed:

Thanks.

Youssef:

You'll be working with me and Nadine.

Nadine:

Unfortunately.

Youssef:

She says that about everyone.

Nadine:

Not everyone.

A notification appears.

LOOPCALL — INCOMING CALL

Tante Layla

Mohamed clicks **Answer**.

The LoopCall window opens in the center of the desktop.

Tante Layla appears on screen.

Salma is sitting beside her.

LOOPCALL — TANTE LAYLA

Tante Layla:

السلام عليكم يا ابني... ده مكتب المهندسين بتوع البرامج؟

Mohamed:

Loop. وعليكم السلام. أيوه، حضرتك مع

Tante Layla:

الحمد لله.

أنا عندي كافيه صغير

Salma leans toward the camera.

Salma:

It's my grandmother's.

Tante Layla:

آه ما أنا عارفة يا بنتي

She looks back at Mohamed.

Tante Layla:

أنا مش عايزة حاجة معقدة

عايزة السيستم يفكر الطلبات

ويعرف الأسعار

ولو حد زبون دائم ياخذ حاجة زيادة

حاجات بسيطة يعني

Tarek suddenly sends a message in WhatsApp.

Tarek:

WE CAN ABSOLUTELY DO THAT.

Youssef replies immediately.

Youssef:

Don't promise timelines.

Tarek:

I wasn't.

Nadine:

You literally just did.

Salma looks at the screen.

Salma:

You're the new developer?

Mohamed:

Apparently.

Salma:

Great.

My grandmother's entire savings are apparently your first assignment.

Mohamed stops typing.

Mohamed:

When you say it like that—

Salma:

How else should I say it?

Tante Layla laughs.

Tante Layla:

أنا واثقة فيه.

Salma looks at her.

Salma:

Teta, you've known him for twelve minutes.

Tante Layla:

وشه كويس.

Youssef sends:

Alright.

Mohamed, I'll send you the first task.

The LoopCall ends.

MAILLOOP — NEW EMAIL

From: Youssef

Subject: Tante Layla — First Build

Start with the menu.

Coffee, tea, croissant.

Names and prices.

Make it appear when the register opens.

Attachment:

Tante_Layla_Menu.txt

Mohamed downloads the file.

A desktop event occurs.

SYSTEM

LoopCode unlocked.

The LoopCode icon appears on the dock.

SHIFT ONE — VARIABLES

THE FIRST TASK

Mohamed opens Tante_Layla_Menu.txt .

The file contains:

```
Coffee - 50 EGP
Tea - 35 EGP
Croissant - 40 EGP
```

He opens LoopCode.

He starts writing:

```
printf("Coffee - 50 EGP\n");
printf("Tea - 35 EGP\n");
printf("Croissant - 40 EGP\n");
```

He runs it.

LOOPCODE — OUTPUT

```
Coffee - 50 EGP
Tea - 35 EGP
Croissant - 40 EGP
```

Success.

Mohamed leans back.

A WhatsApp notification appears.

Nadine:

You done?

Mohamed:

Yeah.

Nadine:

That fast?

Mohamed:

It's three lines.

Nadine:

Interesting.

Send me a screenshot.

Mohamed sends it.

Nadine sees it.

Nadine:

Oh.

Mohamed:

What?

Nadine:

Nothing.

Mohamed:

That's never good.

Nadine doesn't respond.

Then—

WHATSUPP — SALMA

Salma:

Teta wants the coffee price changed.

Mohamed:

To?

Salma:

45.

Mohamed:

Okay.

Mohamed searches LoopCode.

Changes:

50 → 45

Another message.

Salma:

Also the receipt needs 45.

Mohamed:

Okay.

Another.

Salma:

Register too.

Another.

Salma:

And the sign.

Mohamed stops.

He searches the code.

There are multiple 50 s.

He changes them.

Another message.

Salma:

And Friday is discount day.

Mohamed stares at the code.

Mohamed:

...

He opens LoopCode again.

There are now several unrelated numbers.

He changes one.

Runs.

Something else still shows 50 .

He changes it.

Runs again.

Another one.

He finally sends:

Mohamed:

Why are there so many 50s?

Nadine replies immediately.

Nadine:

Ah.

Mohamed:

"Ah"??

Nadine:

You're discovering variables.

Mohamed:

I'm discovering pain.

Nadine:

Same thing at this stage.

Youssef sends a message.

Youssef:

Think of a variable as one named place that holds the value.

Instead of remembering where every `50` is.

Mohamed looks at the code.

Youssef continues:

Give the price a name.

Mohamed creates:

```
int coffeePrice = 45;
```

Then uses:

```
printf("Coffee - %d EGP\n", coffeePrice);
```

He runs it.

OUTPUT

```
Coffee - 45 EGP
```

Mohamed changes:

```
coffeePrice = 40;
```

Runs again.

Everything updates.

Mohamed pauses.

Mohamed:

Okay.

Nadine:

What?

Mohamed:

That's actually useful.

Nadine:

Don't sound so surprised.

END OF SHIFT ONE

WHATSUPP — YOUSSEF

First day.

First bug.

First fix.

Not bad.

A second message:

Get some sleep.

A third:

Gate is waiting tomorrow.

SYSTEM NOTIFICATION

Gate 1 unlocked.

LoopCode opens automatically.

GATE 1 — VARIABLES

The LoopCode interface switches to:

PRACTICE MODE

Youssef's portrait appears inside a small panel.

Youssef:

Let's see if you actually understood what you just fixed.

The player solves variable-based tasks.

The gate requires the existing mastery logic.

After three consecutive successful responses:

SYSTEM

Gate Cleared.

Shift Two unlocked.

SHIFT TWO — CONDITIONALS

LOOPOS — MORNING

Mohamed logs in.

Before he can open anything:

WHATSUPP — SALMA

Morning.

Mohamed:

Morning.

Salma:

Teta has another request.

Mohamed:

Of course she does.

Salma:

If someone orders more than 200 EGP—

Mohamed:

Discount?

Salma:

Exactly.

Mohamed:

How much?

Salma:

10%.

Mohamed:

Got it.

A new MailLoop email arrives.

From: Youssef

Subject: Discount Rule

If the order total is 200 EGP or more:

Apply 10%.

Otherwise:

No discount.

Attachment:

`discount_requirements.txt`

Mohamed opens LoopCode.

He writes the logic.

The first version is wrong.

He tests:

Order total: 200

OUTPUT

No discount.

Mohamed stares.

WHATSUPP — NADINE

Boundary.

Mohamed:

What boundary?

Nadine:

Read the requirement again.

Mohamed opens the email.

200 EGP or more.

He realizes the problem.

Mohamed:

Oh.

Nadine:

Exactly.

He changes the condition.

Runs again.

OUTPUT

10% discount applied.

Nadine replies:

Better.

Mohamed:

That's all?

Nadine:

You want a medal?

Mohamed:

Maybe.

Nadine:

No.

LATER

A new LoopCall arrives.

Tante Layla

Mohamed answers.

Tante Layla:

يا ابني أنا جريت السيستم

حلو أوي

بس عايزة حاجة

Mohamed:

إيه؟

Tante Layla:

الزبون اللي بيطلب كثير

ده لازم نحبه شوية

Salma laughs.

Salma:

She means the discount.

Tante Layla:

ما أنا قلت خصم.

Mohamed:

تمام.

Tante Layla smiles.

Tante Layla:

رينا يوفقك يا ابني.

The call ends.

END OF SHIFT TWO

WHATSUPP — SALMA

You actually fixed it.

Mohamed:

Was that surprising?

Salma:

A little.

Mohamed:

Thanks... I think.

Salma:

Teta likes you.

Mohamed:

She likes everyone.

Salma:

Not everyone.

The message stays on screen.

Mohamed doesn't reply immediately.

GATE 2 — CONDITIONALS

LoopCode switches to Practice Mode.

Youssef appears.

Youssef:

Boundary conditions.

Everyone's least favorite two words.

Let's see it.

Tasks test:

- `if`
- `else`
- comparison operators
- boundary conditions
- discount logic

After mastery:

SYSTEM

Gate Cleared.

Shift Three unlocked.

SHIFT THREE — LOOPS

LOOPOS DESKTOP

A notification appears.

New MailLoop message — Youssef

Mohamed opens it.

Subject: We have a problem.

Attachment:

`Morning_Orders.txt`

The file contains forty orders.

Youssef sends a WhatsApp message.

Youssef:

Tante Layla wants to test the system against a real morning.

Mohamed:

Forty orders?

Youssef:

Forty orders.

Mohamed opens LoopCode.

He starts copying his existing order-processing code.

One order.

Another.

Another.

Another.

The code gets longer.

WHATSUPP — NADINE

How many times are you going to copy that?

Mohamed:

Forty.

Nadine:

You're joking.

Mohamed:

No.

Nadine:

Mohamed.

Youssef sends:

You know the computer can repeat things, right?

Mohamed stops.

Mohamed:

Explain.

Youssef:

You give it the instructions once.

Then tell it how many times to repeat them.

Mohamed thinks.

He replaces the repeated blocks with a loop.

Runs it.

OUTPUT

The same forty orders are processed.

Mohamed stares at the screen.

Mohamed:

That's...

Nadine:

Yeah.

Mohamed:

I just wasted an hour.

Nadine:

Welcome.

THE BUG

Mohamed runs the full file.

39 orders are processed correctly.

One isn't.

LOOPCODE

Order 39 — Discount not applied

Mohamed checks the code.

Nadine sends:

What's different about 39?

Mohamed traces the loop.

He realizes the loop stops one order early.

Mohamed:

It ends before the last order.

Nadine:

Classic.

Mohamed:

Is that a technical term?

Nadine:

It is the most technical term.

Mohamed fixes the boundary.

Runs again.

OUTPUT

```
40 / 40 orders processed  
40 / 40 discounts calculated correctly
```

Nadine:

Okay.

That's actually clean.

Mohamed smiles.

Mohamed:

Say that again.

Nadine:

Don't get used to it.

GATE 3 — LOOPS

LoopCode opens.

Youssef appears.

Youssef:

Forty orders.

Let's see it hold up on more than forty.

Tasks focus on:

- loop construction
- stopping conditions
- boundaries
- off-by-one errors
- combining loops with previous conditional logic

After three consecutive successful responses:

SYSTEM

Gate Cleared.

Final milestone unlocked.

CAPSTONE — “GRAND OPENING”

LOOPOS — EARLY MORNING

Mohamed's desktop loads.

New wallpaper.

TANTE LAYLA — OPENING DAY

A system notification appears:

LoopCall scheduled — 09:00 AM

At 09:00:

LOOPCALL — TANTE LAYLA

Tante Layla appears.

Behind her, the coffee shop is visible.

Salma is beside her.

Tante Layla:

جاهزين؟

Mohamed looks at Nadine's status.

Nadine: Online

She joins the call.

Nadine:

We're ready.

Tante Layla smiles.

Tante Layla:

رينا يستر.

The call ends.

THE SYSTEM GOES LIVE

Mohamed opens the register simulation through LoopCode.

First order.

Success.

Second.

Success.

Third.

Success.

A fourth order arrives.

The customer qualifies for the discount.

The system doesn't apply it.

LOOPCODE — ERROR

Expected discount: 10%

Actual discount: 0%

A critical notification appears.

Discount calculation failed.

Mohamed opens WhatsApp.

Mohamed:

Nadine.

Instant reply.

Nadine:

I see it.

Mohamed:

I'm checking.

Nadine:

Send me the current code.

Mohamed shares the file.

Nadine opens it.

Nadine:

I found it.

Mohamed:

Where?

Nadine:

You're checking the discount before the entire order is finished.

Mohamed looks at the loop.

Mohamed:

So it's checking half the order.

Nadine:

Exactly.

Finish calculating the total first.

Then check the condition.

Mohamed moves the condition.

Runs the test.

OUTPUT

Order processed.

Total calculated.

Discount applied.

Mohamed waits.

Another order.

A woman qualifies.

RECEIPT

Subtotal: 250 EGP
Discount: 25 EGP
Total: 225 EGP

SYSTEM

Grand Opening System: Operational

A LoopCall opens.

Tante Layla is smiling.

Tante Layla:

اشتغل!

Salma looks at Mohamed through the camera.

Salma:

You fixed it.

Mohamed:

We fixed it.

Nadine sends a WhatsApp message:

Don't get sentimental.

Mohamed replies:

Too late.

Tante Layla laughs.

Tante Layla:

أنا فلتلك يا سلمى.

Salma:

What?

Tante Layla:

وشه كويس.

Salma looks at Mohamed.

A pause.

Salma:

...yeah.

Maybe.

CHAPTER END

The LoopCall closes.

Mohamed is alone again.

The desktop is quiet.

Then:

WHATSUPP — YOUSSEF

Good work.

A second message:

You actually stuck with it.

Mohamed looks at the message.

He doesn't joke this time.

Mohamed:

Thanks.

Youssef:

Get some sleep.

Tomorrow we start the next one.

MAILLOOP

Subject: Congratulations — Promotion

Your position at Loop has been updated.

SYSTEM MODAL

PROMOTED

Intern → Experienced Junior

The desktop wallpaper slowly changes.

The workspace looks slightly better.

A new notification appears:

New Shift Available

Then another:

New Side Project Task Available

Mohamed looks at the desktop.

The cursor moves toward **WhatsApp**.

Cut to black.

END OF CHAPTER ONE